

34) Use the vector $u = (u_1, \dots, u_n)$ to verify the following algebraic properties of $\mathbb{R}^n$.

a) $u + (-u) = (-u) + u = 0$

b) $c(du) = (cd)u$ for all scalars c and d

Solution: a) $(-u) = (-1) \cdot u = (-1) \cdot (u_1, \dots, u_n) = (-1 \cdot u_1, \dots, -1 \cdot u_n)$
(Scalar multiplication)

$$= (-u_1, \dots, -u_n) \therefore u + (-u) = (u_1, \dots, u_n) + (-u_1, \dots, -u_n)$$

$$= (u_1 + (-u_1), \dots, u_n + (-u_n)) \text{ (Vector addition)}$$

$$= ((-u_1) + u_1, \dots, (-u_n) + u_n) \text{ (Algebraic property (i))}$$

$$= (0, 0, \dots, 0) \text{ (Algebraic property (iv))} = 0$$

b) $du = d(u_1, \dots, u_n) = (du_1, \dots, du_n)$ (Scalar multiplication)

$$c(du) = c(du_1, \dots, du_n) = (c(du_1), \dots, c(du_n)) \text{ (Scalar multiplication)}$$

$$= (\cancel{cd} (cd)u_1, \dots, (cd)u_n) \text{ (Algebraic property vii)}$$

$$= (cd)(u_1, \dots, u_n) \text{ (Scalar multiplication)} = (cd)u \quad \square$$